A FIELD GUIDE FOR APP BUILDERS

20 APP UX PATTERNS

Real apps. Specific screens. Ideas you can apply.

INSIDE THE GUIDE

01 One Clear Promise

02 Complex Work, Simple Flow

03 Data That Leads To Action

04 Accessibility Is The Experience

05 Delight With A Job To Do

Curated from Apple Design Awards 2025-26 and Google Play Best of 2025.

Research checked: 15 October 2026

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Study the move, not the pixels.

This is a research shortlist for founders, designers and builders. Each entry points to a real product and one interaction worth examining. Open the store listing, inspect the relevant screen or flow, and adapt the principle to your own user's job.

01

Pick the job

Choose one user problem you are currently designing for.

02

Inspect the flow

Look beyond the hero screenshot: entry, action, feedback and next step.

03

Translate the principle

Sketch your own version using your content, constraints and brand.

04

Test it

Check comprehension, accessibility and the first successful outcome.

SELECTION NOTES

The 20 products span utility, creativity, planning, accessibility and learning. Apple and Google editorial selections are used as discovery signals; the 'Try it' lines are our design interpretation. Rankings, revenue and conversion claims are intentionally excluded. Product interfaces and availability may change.

01 / ONE CLEAR PROMISE

A product can feel generous when its first action is obvious.

01 grug

Daily wisdom / iOS

STUDY Open, read one thought, leave. Notice the hand-drawn interface and absence of account setup.

TRY IT Reduce the first session to one useful outcome before asking for a profile.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

02 Focus Friend

Focus timer / Android

STUDY A small character turns a focus session into a reason to put the phone down.

TRY IT Let the reward reinforce the user's real goal, not screen time.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

03 iA Writer

Writing / iOS

STUDY The editor keeps words central; the library and preview appear when needed.

TRY IT Hide secondary tools until the user is ready to switch tasks.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

04 Mela

Recipe manager / iOS

STUDY Cooking mode emphasizes the current step while timers remain close at hand.

TRY IT Design around the moment of use, not just the content catalog.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

02 / COMPLEX WORK, SIMPLE FLOW

Show the result first, then reveal the power underneath.

05 Detail

AI video editor / iOS

STUDY Camera-like capture leads into silence removal, multi-angle edits and a teleprompter.

TRY IT Give beginners a short path to a finished artifact; keep advanced editing available.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

06 Moises

Music creation / iOS

STUDY Stem separation becomes a visible, playable set of tracks rather than an abstract AI feature.

TRY IT Make an invisible model output tangible and reversible.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

07 Capy

Meeting translation / iOS

STUDY A friendly character holds attention while transcription and translation run.

TRY IT Use the waiting state to explain progress; deliver the useful output immediately.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

08 Edits

Mobile video editor / Android

STUDY Capture, edit and publish live in a creator-oriented mobile workflow.

TRY IT Organize tools in the order of the user's job, not by technical feature type.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

03 / DATA THAT LEADS TO ACTION

Great data screens answer 'what should I do next?'.

09 Structured

Daily planner / iOS

STUDY A scannable timeline makes tasks, free time and breaks visible together.

TRY IT Show capacity and recovery alongside commitments.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

10 The Outsiders

Athlete tracker / iOS

STUDY Training load, sleep and recovery combine in one readiness view.

TRY IT Translate several metrics into a decision cue, while keeping detail inspectable.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

11 Tide Guide

Tide and weather / iOS

STUDY Dense forecast data is layered into readable full-screen charts and widgets.

TRY IT Start with the time-sensitive answer; reveal detail on demand.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

12 Moonlitt

Moon tracker / iOS

STUDY Onboarding and platform-specific views make astronomy approachable.

TRY IT Use a strong visual model to explain a changing natural system.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

04 / ACCESSIBILITY IS THE EXPERIENCE

Support different people in the primary journey, not as an afterthought.

13 Hearing Buddy

Live captions / iOS

STUDY Conversation captions and Watch alerts address real listening moments.

TRY IT Put critical information on the device and modality that can reach the user.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

14 Speechify

Text to audio / iOS

STUDY Documents, scans and web pages become listenable through an approachable interface.

TRY IT Offer alternate input and output modes for the same user task.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

15 Guitar Wiz

Music utility / iOS

STUDY Spoken chord guidance, Dynamic Type and contrast options support more players.

TRY IT Test the core action with VoiceOver and without relying on color alone.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

16 Katha Room

Children's stories / iOS

STUDY Folklore-inspired art and sound give familiar bedtime flows a distinct cultural voice.

TRY IT Make the identity of the audience visible in content and interface details.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

05 / DELIGHT WITH A JOB TO DO

Personality works best when it supports comprehension and action.

17 (Not Boring) Camera

Camera / iOS

STUDY Large controls and haptic dials turn settings into a tactile experience.

TRY IT Use distinctive interaction where immediate feedback helps mastery.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

18 Harvee

Recovery companion / iOS

STUDY A small avatar helps interpret heart-rate, sleep and activity signals.

TRY IT Use a character to humanize a complex state, while keeping the underlying data accessible.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

19 Pingo AI

Language learning / Android

STUDY Conversation practice makes the learner produce language rather than just browse lessons.

TRY IT Design the learning loop around doing, feedback and another attempt.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

20 Goodnotes

Notes / Android tablets

STUDY A large-screen canvas supports handwriting, documents and annotation together.

TRY IT Adapt the workspace to the device; do more than stretch a phone layout.

OPEN APP **EDITORIAL SOURCE**

THE 5-QUESTION DESIGN REVIEW

Turn inspiration into a better app.

01 Can a new user reach one useful outcome in the first minute?

02 Does each screen make the next action clear?

03 Are complex results translated into a decision or action?

04 Can someone complete the core task with assistive settings?

05 Does personality help the task, rather than interrupt it?

Sources: Apple Design Awards 2026 + 2025; Google Play Best of 2025;
and each product's official App Store or Play listing. Tap the links on each card.

Independent editorial selection. No affiliation with the products listed.